

January

18

Also on this day

1871 The second German Empire was proclaimed following the unification of German states during the Franco-Prussian War.

1912 The ill-fated expedition of British explorer Robert Falcon Scott reached the South Pole only to find that Norwegian adventurer Roald Amundsen had arrived a month earlier. Scott's entire team perished on the return journey to base camp.

2002 The civil war in Sierra Leone officially ended after 11 years of conflict.

1943

Bread ban

Sliced bread was banned in the USA to reduce the costs for additional labour and equipment during World War II. However, the new measure only lasted two months.



1593

The Battle of Nong Sa Rai

King Naresuan of Siam killed Crown Prince Minchit Sra of Burma in an elephant battle that ended the Burmese invasion. The day is now celebrated as Royal Thai Armed Forces Day.



Born this day

1884 Elena Arizmendi Mejia, Mexican women's rights activist. She set up the Neutral White Cross Organization to nurse the injured during the Mexican Revolution.

1911

Landing at sea

An aircraft landed on a ship for the first time. The risky manoeuvre was carried out successfully by pilot Eugene Ely on the flight deck of the battleship USS *Pennsylvania*, which was anchored in San Francisco Bay, USA.

